

like Narmada Bachao Andolan.

CLASS 7: SOCIAL SCIENCE

■ The chapter 'Struggles for Equality' in ***Social and Political Life-II*** that described the Tawa Matsya Sangh's fight for the rights of displaced forest-dwellers of the Satpura forest of Madhya Pradesh in the mid-'90s has been deleted

CLASS 6: SOCIAL SCIENCE

■ In ***Social and Political Life-I***, an introductory chapter to the concept of democracy has been deleted. It explained how people's participation, conflict resolution, equality and justice influence the working of a democratic government.

■ In the same book, a big chunk from the chapter 'Diversity and Discrimination' has been dropped. It included references to caste rules not allowing the 'untouchables' to take on work other than what they were meant to do, how people from the dominant castes did not allow them to take water from the village well or enter temples, and how their children could not sit next to the children from higher castes in school.

CLASS 6: HISTORY

■ In the textbook ***Our Pasts-I***, sentences on the hereditary nature of varnas, ashramas (the four stages of life) and classification of people as untouchables have been deleted.

■ In the same book, a mention of women and Shudras not being allowed to study the Vedas in ancient India has been dropped from a section on the Puranas in the chapter 'Buildings, Paintings and Books'.



"NO ONE CAN DENY GODSE KILLED GANDHI OR REMOVE MUGHAL HISTORY. THOSE MAKING NOISES SHOULD WAIT FOR THE NEW TEXTBOOKS UNDER NCF"

–J.S. RAJPUT
Former Director, NCERT

sentatives of the RSS-affiliated Bharatiya Shikshan Mandal and Shiksha Sanskriti Utthan Nyas, former NCERT director Rajput and educationist Shankar Sharan, who had already been demanding revision of "the Marxist version of school textbooks" and rewriting them from an 'Indian perspective'.

HOW CONGRESS CHANGED TEXTBOOKS

If the BJP is being reviled for attempting to rewrite history, the Congress too is considered guilty of that sin. Most right-wing thinkers trace the alleged "tilt" towards the Mughals right to the first nationalist histories written for schools after Independence to M.C. Chagla, who was the education minister in the Congress governments from 1963-1966. He had initiated the writing of new history textbooks in the 1960s to project Indian history from a 'secular', 'unbiased' and 'anti-colonial' perspective. He set up a committee on history education, which commissioned a number of textbooks to be authored by leading historians such as Romila Thapar, R.S. Sharma, Satish Chandra, Bipan Chandra and Arjun Dev. Chagla's successor Saiyid Nurul Hasan monitored the exercise from 1971. Hasan is accused of encouraging a particular set of writers who left a Marxist imprint on history textbooks. The noted historian Ramachandra Guha also